

The First AI Lesson

A classroom activity that builds critical AI habits

The First AI Lesson

A classroom-ready activity that teaches students to question AI answers as carefully as their own.

Why This Lesson First

Before students learn to use AI well, they need to learn to question it. The most dangerous AI skill is confident use without critical thinking. This activity builds that habit from day one.

Lesson Overview

Time: 45 to 60 minutes

Materials: Access to any AI tool (1 device per group works fine)

Goal: Students experience AI getting something wrong and develop a personal verification habit

Step 1: The Bait (10 min)

Ask students: 'What do you think AI knows?' Take a few answers. Then ask: 'What do you think AI gets wrong?' Most students will say very little - they assume it is basically a search engine that is always right.

Step 2: The Test (15 min)

Have each group ask the AI a question they already know the answer to - something from their current unit, their home culture, their town, or recent events. Document the AI answer.

>> EXAMPLE PROMPTS TO USE

- 'Who won [recent local sports event]?' - 'What is [a word in another language students speak] in English?' - 'What happened in [recent school or community news]?'

Step 3: The Catch (10 min)

Groups report back. What did AI get right? What did it get wrong? What did it say confidently that was incorrect? Key question: 'How would you know if you did not already know the answer?'

Step 4: Build the Habit (10 min)

Each student writes their personal AI verification rule - not a class rule, their own rule in their own words.

>> STUDENT PROMPT

'When I use AI, I will always verify by _____ before I trust an answer about _____.'

Discussion Debrief

- What is the difference between AI being wrong and AI lying?
- Does a tool being wrong make it useless? Why or why not?
- Who is responsible for what you produce when AI helped?

Educator Note

This lesson works at any level. The questions change; the habit does not. Students who learn to verify early carry that skill into every future tool they use.